

Mines & unexploded ordnance

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Do not approach, touch, move, collect or attempt to dismantle a suspicious object, munition or wire. Keep other people away from a safe position. Avoid abandoned positions, disturbed ground and routes that have not been assessed after fighting. Report only through a safe verified channel; do not enter a hazardous area to identify an object.

Do now.

**Stop approaching**

01

Do not move closer to inspect, photograph or identify the object. Small fragments and abandoned everyday objects can conceal explosive hazards.

**Keep others away**

02

Warn people from where you are safe. Keep children and animals away without crossing suspect ground. Do not place a marker beside the object.

**Avoid uncertain routes**

03

Stay out of abandoned military sites and recently fought-over or marked hazardous areas. A road, field or house that was once safe may no longer be.

**Share the location safely**

04

From a safe place, describe the general location to verified demining, humanitarian or emergency contacts. Do not broadcast a precise route that invites others to approach.

**Do not attempt a rescue into suspect ground**

05

Call specialist help when reachable. Entering a suspected mined area can create additional casualties; do not improvise a clearance or dismantling method.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If no qualified contact answers, keep the area avoided and warn trusted people from a safe location. Do not treat the lack of an official sign or report as proof that it is safe.

Watch for.

Never burn, bury, throw, transport or disturb an object. This guide cannot determine a safe distance or a safe escape path through mined ground.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Teach children a simple rule: do not touch, move away from the hazard without approaching it, tell a trusted adult. Use routes confirmed safe by qualified local assessment; no appearance-based test proves ground is clear.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

ICRC · [Weapon contamination](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/unexploded-ordnance/>